

ART EXHIBITION NOTES

Sardonic and Literary

Maurice Sievan, whose last show in 1945, was a thing of low-keyed suburban landscapes and a few figures, has turned to robust and witty literary allusions. His current show which opened yesterday at the Salpeter gallery to continue through March 27, deals with his reactions to war. In a sardonic mood, he has depicted Poe-like ideas in "Evanescence," a portrait of a lady, the low-toned and soft colors of which make the obvious literary intention quietly grim. "Wherefore" shows a man astride a tombstone, unable in his conceited glee to recognize his own finale. Other satires are "Variation on a Theme" and "Twas Ever Thus."

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ART NEWS

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Maurice Sievan [Salpeter; Mar. 15-27], who studied with such seeming irreconcilables as André Lhôte and the National Academy and who now teaches painting at Queens College as well as directing the Art Association of Summit, N. J., brings a painstaking technical competence to the illustration of not very subtle allegories. He draws well, and carefully applies a dark, filmy paint whose harmonies reflect his pessimistic outlook. Man's plight is his chief subject—a young girl and her skull are juxtaposed, a man drowning in interplanetary space clutches at an indifferent world. Content is over-ambitious, but what Sievan loses in feebleness of gesture and idea he almost makes up in emotional intensity. \$400-\$1,000.

THE NEW YORKER

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MAURICE SIEVAN—A former landscapist turns to more mystical subjects, with uneven but occasionally interesting results. (Salpeter, 128 E. 56th St. Weekdays, noon to 6 P.M.; through March 27.)

Salpeter Gallery.

Now that Maurice Sievan has done something about the cosmic disturbances that have been fretting him perhaps he'll settle down to painting once again the silvery-toned landscapes we knew and liked so well. Sievan's profundities are difficult to rationalize, and why bother anyway when the paintings have so little appeal? Make no mistake—there are passages of great beauty in this painting and good drawing, too, but the service they are put to defies intelligent description. Go see for yourself at the Salpeter Gallery.

HELEN CARLSON.

Maurice Sievan at the Salpeter Gallery paints grim, satirical commentaries on modern man's fate in a world with which he has lost connection. The subjects are incongruous and surreal; the handling, academic and impressionistic, with a careful building up of warm evanescent color glazes. Typical is "Aviation" with its apportioned human forms whirling helplessly in space, a latter day aerial Bosch. S. H.

THE ART DIGEST

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Sievan Changes

Maurice Sievan, in his exhibition of paintings at the Harry Salpeter Gallery, has completely abandoned his former preoccupation with the trivia of suburban scenes for a subjective approach to subject matter, which results in an emotional and imaginative presentation of his themes. He paints more broadly with far larger elements of design, yet retaining his gift of color that is appreciably accordant with his subjects.

The work is uneven, as is natural with so decided a change in esthetic approach and handling, but the majority of the canvases are successful. An outstanding one is *Whither O, Lord*. The witty *Aviation Figures*, and the two-figure composition, *Variation on a Theme* display technical means completely adequate to original conceptions. The exhibition creates a world of fantasy, which is in the main convincing. (Through March 27.)—M. B.